

SSID Hiding (Hidden Wi-Fi Network)

SSID hiding means that the name of your Wi-Fi network is not shown when someone searches for nearby Wi-Fi connections. Normally, when you open the Wi-Fi settings on your phone or laptop, you can see a list of available networks. If SSID hiding is turned on, your network will not appear in that list. To connect, you must already know the Wi-Fi name (SSID) and the password, and you have to enter them manually.

Some people hide their SSID because they think it makes their Wi-Fi network safer. It does make the network less visible to people nearby, but it is **not** a complete security feature. Anyone with the right network tools can still find a hidden Wi-Fi network.

Advantage of Hiding the SSID

One advantage is that your Wi-Fi network is not easily visible to everyone around you. This can stop casual users or neighbors from trying to connect because they cannot see the network name in the available Wi-Fi list. It also helps keep the list of nearby Wi-Fi networks less crowded.

Disadvantage of Hiding the SSID

One disadvantage is that it does not provide real security. A hidden SSID can still be found using Wi-Fi scanning software. It can also be inconvenient because every new phone, laptop, or tablet must be connected manually by entering the exact Wi-Fi name and password. If you forget the network name, connecting becomes more difficult.